

O wized eyes resplendent

In memory of Robert Coon (1931 - 2021)

Text: Kenan Schaeferkofer, 2021

Music: Gustav Holst, 1921

THAXTED 13.13.14.12.13.14

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, 3/4 time, with a key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, G#). The melody is accompanied by a series of chords indicated above the staff. The lyrics are arranged in three systems, each with three lines of text. The first system of lyrics is: '1 O wiz - ened eyes re - splen - dent, we seek the things you saw, 2 O ea - ger lips of bless - ing, speak grace for us to - day, 3 O trem - b'ling hands of ser - vice, wrap arms a - round us all.' The second system is: 'that urged you to such great - ness, and hum - bled you in awe. for - give us and our mourn - ing, our stub - born, pet - ty ways. Take res - pite from your la - bors, and joy in heav - en's call.' The third system is: 'We strive now, as you once strove, toward the bea - con, toward the Light. We speak now, as you once spoke, prayers and stor - ies, ho - ly jest, We fight now, as you once fought, not with sword, but plow - share hewn.' The fourth system is: 'With fore - bears in - vit - ing, it beck - ons yet more bright. to bol - ster worn hearts and in - spire us to our best. Through clang - or - ous war drums you hummed a dif - f'rent tune:' The fifth system is: 'Though tear - y eyes may hin - der, and sor - row shroud our way, You ut - tered bless'd ass - ur - ance, through strife, your words did calm, Ev - ry note is one of jus - tice, each tear can shat - ter chains,' The sixth system is: 'what seems to us like eve - ning may just be break of day. there is a - far in Gi - le - ad, vouch - safed for us a Balm. ev - ry sigh be - comes a rush of wind, set free a - cross the plains.'

B E F#7/C# B E F# G#m

1 O wiz - ened eyes re - splen - dent, we seek the things you saw,
2 O ea - ger lips of bless - ing, speak grace for us to - day,
3 O trem - b'ling hands of ser - vice, wrap arms a - round us all.

E F#7/C# B Emaj7 C#m B

that urged you to such great - ness, and hum - bled you in awe.
for - give us and our mourn - ing, our stub - born, pet - ty ways.
Take res - pite from your la - bors, and joy in heav - en's call.

F# G#m F# B F# B E

We strive now, as you once strove, toward the bea - con, toward the Light.
We speak now, as you once spoke, prayers and stor - ies, ho - ly jest,
We fight now, as you once fought, not with sword, but plow - share hewn.

G#m E B C#m/E G#m F#

With fore - bears in - vit - ing, it beck - ons yet more bright.
to bol - ster worn hearts and in - spire us to our best.
Through clang - or - ous war drums you hummed a dif - f'rent tune:

E F#7/C# B/D# E F# G#m

Though tear - y eyes may hin - der, and sor - row shroud our way,
You ut - tered bless'd ass - ur - ance, through strife, your words did calm,
Ev - ry note is one of jus - tice, each tear can shat - ter chains,

E F#7/C# B Emaj7 C#m B

what seems to us like eve - ning may just be break of day.
there is a - far in Gi - le - ad, vouch - safed for us a Balm.
ev - ry sigh be - comes a rush of wind, set free a - cross the plains.